Extended essay: commentary for example essay			
DP subject: (Subject-focused essay)	**Design Technology**		
DP subjects: (Interdisciplinary essay)		Interdisciplinary framework:	
Research question:	With reference to structural integrity and environmental consideration, what would be the most suitable cement alternatives for the construction of stabilized rammed earth structures?		
Assessment details			
Criterion:	Mark awarded:	Commentary: (Incorporating wording from the assessment criteria)	
A: Framework for the essay [Maximum possible mark: 6]	**5**	Research question: Markband 5-6 The research question (RQ) is fully relevant to the topic, easy to understand and thoroughly focused within a clearly defined scope of the essay. Final mark awarded for the descriptor: 6 Research methods: Markband 3-4 The research methods are appropriate to the RQ, their use is mostly appropriate and applied with partial effectiveness. The student has not achieved the next level because some of the tests carried out (primary resources) are applied with partial effectiveness. Final mark awarded for the descriptor: 4 Structure: Markband 5-6 The structural conventions for this type of Design Technology (DT) extended essay (EE) are used effectively. The student has not achieved the maximum mark because a lack of explanation of methods at the beginning of the essay and minor errors such as a lack of reference to author images do not detract from the overall quality of the structure. Final mark for the descriptor: 5	
B: Knowledge and understanding [Maximum possible mark: 6]	**5**	Knowledge: Markband 5-6 The resources used are fully relevant to the RQ and enable the development of strong student knowledge. Final mark for descriptor: 6 Understanding-Terminology: Markband 5-6	

		Relevant terminology is used accurately and consistently. Final mark for descriptor: 6 Understanding-Concepts: Markband 3-4 Some concepts are explained with partial effectiveness. The student demonstrates understanding, but there is a lack of depth in the understanding of some of the concepts explained. Final mark for the descriptor: 4
C: Analysis and line of argument [Maximum possible mark: 6]	**4**	Analysis: Markband 3-4 Throughout the EE, there is evidence of analytical thinking leading to some relevant findings but not consistently. Final mark for the descriptor: 4 Line of argument: Markband 3-4 A partially consistent line of argument links findings, analysis, evaluation, and conclusions throughout the EE. There are some disruptions to the line which do not allow the higher level of achievement. Final mark for the descriptor: 4
D: Discussion and evaluation [Maximum possible mark: 8]	**4**	Discussion: Markband 5-6 The discussion is balanced, but not all findings are supported by evidence. Few are evaluative and supported by evidence. Final mark for the descriptor: 5 Evaluation: Markband 3-4 There is evaluation in some of the findings, but there is a lack of evaluation of the research process, which in this case would have allowed to question the limitations of some of the tests carried out and some irrelevant historical review. Final mark for the descriptor: 4
E: Reflection [Maximum possible mark: 4]	**4**	Evaluative : Markband 4 Reflection on the EE learning experience is predominantly analytical and evaluative. Final mark for the descriptor: 4 Growth : Markband 4 The reflections consistently show evidence of the student's growth and application of transfer skills. Final mark for the descriptor: 4

Total marks awarded	22 /30	
Holistic comment on the essay:	Overall, the student has demonstrated solid research, analytical, and reflective skills in their extended essay. The research question is highly relevant and well-focused, and the essay adheres effectively to the structural conventions of a Design Technology extended essay. The student shows strong knowledge and consistent use of relevant terminology. By further enhancing the application of primary research methods, providing more detailed explanations at the beginning of the essay, and ensuring consistent referencing of images, the structure can be even stronger. Additionally, deepening the understanding of some concepts, maintaining a more consistent line of argument, and offering a more comprehensive evaluation of the research process will further elevate the quality of the analysis and discussion. The reflections show excellent growth and future application of the transfer of skills. The performance in this extended essay is commendable, earning a total of 22 out of 30 marks.	